

Rhetorical Rationale

Implementation of Machine Learning/AI algorithms in scouting and selecting college football players

The way NFL teams scout and evaluate college football talent is changing, and it is becoming increasingly important that organizations adapt to changes. With the steady rise of Machine Learning and AI, there's an opportunity to make the draft process more efficient and expeditious. In this campaign, I explore how these tools can be introduced into scouting through multiple forms of communication, each aimed at a different audience but all working toward the same goal. I aim specifically toward engaged NFL fans and team media, along with an NFL organization, the Tampa Bay Buccaneers, in my campaign. With my artifacts, I push my narrative that data produced through the use of Machine Learning models evaluation is necessary for staying competitive.

Utilizing a letter sent to one NFL organization directly contacting a team is a guaranteed way to present ideas in a way that can't be missed. I acted as a Data Analyst who works in developing Machine Learning models with FSU's Information Technology Services department, and directly contacted the Tampa Bay Buccaneers to explain how the work I have done and models I have created can streamline their process. I ensured professionalism, creating a neat and formal letter that ties in with the credibility of the organization I stated I was a part of. I wrote it in the form of a business letter, as I was directing it toward an organization from my own department. I made these decisions to appeal to ethos specifically, stating that I was writing on behalf of a well-known and respected sports college's data department. My credibility better the odds that the organization will take notice of my information, and opens the door to further development in the topic I am addressing. Overall, the format and style choices used here guarantee that the ideas I want to share are seen, and maximize its professionalism; thus, adding to the likelihood my ideas are considered and utilized.

This genre seeks out Team writers/reporters, along with more invested NFL fans. Many writers/reporters utilize social media as their medium of informing the public of news regarding the team they report on. The material contained in the social media artifact aims to persuade and inform team writers and reporters of the benefits surrounding implementing Machine Learning in the draft process, as to encourage them to pass along the information to the team during press conferences. I acted as a well-known and seasoned draft analyst, this gives the site credibility from someone with lots of experience and knowledge in the subject. I made it in the form of a Twitter/X post as it is regarded as the most used site for sports media and news. I specifically appeal to ethos with this post, as I act as Daniel Jeremiah. As such, this post is likely to reach and be received well by reporters, along with NFL fans. This is the primary factor in why I decided to use this medium. Altogether, these decisions work to make a credible and clear post that showcases the website in my third genre.

I made the choice to use a website to target NFL fans and media. Fans lack capability alone the resources that NFL organizations have, providing this resource shows the potential of the implementation and gains support from the public. Having fan support for this implementation, along with having more fans informed of how Machine Learning can assist in the draft process, assists in the strides needed for it to be utilized by NFL organizations. As such, creating a website that fans can personally utilize to see first-hand how Machine Learning can make scouting and evaluating players easier is the most honest and informative approach. I included a draft board, rankings of college football players, that utilizes a Machine Learning model's algorithms to show the capabilities it has in forming opinions that can be used in decisions. The website has tabs for an explanation of how the model works, as to allow for transparency. Each player will have a screen dedicated to their strengths and weaknesses based on what the model has seen and gathered about said player. I emphasized transparency with this genre, as one of the major concerns with utilizing artificial intelligence is trust. Gaining trust and support is crucial for making steps to further development, this website does this through appealing to logic; each step of the process used being transparent and algorithmic leaves no room for doubt, and makes logical sense for people to understand.

Across each of my genres, my goal stays consistent; build trust through establishing credibility, and make the value of Machine Learning in scouting impossible to ignore. The use of a letter to form direct, credible communication with an organization, influencing notable media voices through the use of social media, and educating fans by allowing them access to tools that utilize Machine Learning models through a website, all follow this approach. Each artifact plays a role in pushing this idea forward. Altogether, the information and methods used all work to showcase how beneficial and valuable the investment in AI and Machine Learning models in sports can be at giving teams another edge in a league where small advantages make monumental differences.